# Irinotecan · every three weeks

The aim is to control advanced bowel cancer and symptoms. The team reviews how well treatment is working and whether side effects remain acceptable; there is no single fixed number of cycles for everyone.

**Advanced / metastatic colorectal cancer** · NCCP 00213 v7 · Document revised 4 November 2026

**Your personal plan:** this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

## My overall treatment

Irinotecan on Day 1 every 21 days while beneficial and tolerable. There is no home chemotherapy pump. Blood counts are checked weekly, including between infusion visits.

**A 21-day reference cycle**

Irinotecan on Day 1 every 21 days while beneficial and tolerable. There is no home chemotherapy pump. Blood counts are checked weekly, including between infusion visits.

## Your treatment schedule

| Day 1 | Every week | Through Day 21 |
|---|---|---|
| Day-ward irinotecan. Report early cramps or sweating immediately. | Full blood count, including between infusions. No home pump. | Use delayed-diarrhoea plan; next treatment only after recovery and review. |

Your team confirms the active phase and dates. Symptoms may occur during or after treatment; there are no guaranteed safe days.

## My tests and checks

| When | What is checked | Timing / reason |
|---|---|---|
| **Before** | **Baseline bloods**<br>Required by regimen | Blood count, kidney and liver function before starting. |
| **During** | **Weekly full blood count**<br>Required by regimen | Every week, including the two weeks between 21-day infusions. |
| **Before each cycle** | **Kidneys / liver / symptoms**<br>Required by regimen | Kidney and liver results, bowel symptoms, hydration and medicines reviewed before more treatment. |
| **After / review** | **Recovery / scans / markers**<br>Team-agreed plan | Follow unresolved effects and the individual cancer review plan; no universal scan or marker interval. |

## Between treatments

- No guaranteed safe days: report fever, sudden illness, diarrhoea or poor intake promptly.
- Symptoms can continue after pump removal and after treatment ends.

Confirm weekly blood-test appointments, anti-sickness medicines, written diarrhoea instructions and working urgent contacts.

**When to get help**

**Call 112 / 999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**



Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

# What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

### 1 Hair / scalp

**Irinotecan**

Hair thinning or loss may occur. Ask about practical support.

### 2 Mouth / swallowing

**Irinotecan**

Report ulcers or pain affecting eating or drinking.

### 3 Breathing / reaction

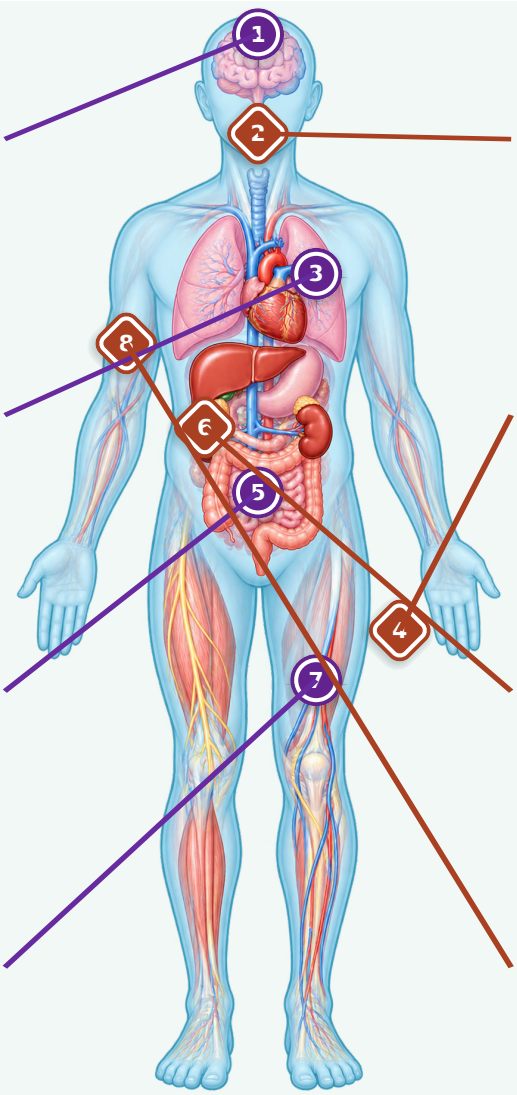
**Irinotecan**

New breathlessness, wheeze or severe breathing difficulty needs urgent assessment.

### 4 Sweating / early reaction

**Irinotecan**

Cramps, sweating or diarrhoea during infusion: tell the nurse immediately.




### 5 Bowel / stoma

**Irinotecan**

Delayed diarrhoea after 24 hours needs your written plan; fever or dehydration needs urgent advice.

### 6 Hydration / urine

**Irinotecan-related fluid loss**

Reduced urine, dizziness or inability to replace fluids needs prompt advice.

### 7 Blood / infection

**Irinotecan**

Keep weekly blood tests. Fever, shivers or sudden illness: call oncology immediately.

### 8 Infusion access

**Treatment delivery**

Report pain, swelling or leakage during infusion. This regimen has no home pump.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

New breathing difficulty, chest pain, collapse, severe diarrhoea or inability to drink require prompt assessment.

**When to get help**

**Call 112 / 999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

**Call oncology immediately:** temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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# Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

**FRONT / CONTACTS**

## My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

**Irinotecan · every three weeks**

Irinotecan Day 1 every 21 days · weekly blood counts · no home chemotherapy pump.

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

**Daytime (EXAMPLE)** 087 12345678

**Out of hours (EXAMPLE)** 087 87654321

**Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.**
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

**BACK / TREATMENT RECORD**

## My cycle record

Rolling record — follow your agreed treatment plan.

| Cycle | Date / initials |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

**FOLD centre — do not cut**

## Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

## Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

### iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

### Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

## Your local contacts and resources

**Oncology daytime:** 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

**EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.**

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.



Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.